SALESFORCE ADMIN COURSE

EPISODE 14 • STUDY NOTES

Lookup vs Master-Detail Relationships in Salesforce Complete Guide

A complete, easy-to-revise breakdown of the video — with tables, multiple diagrams, and step-by-step demos.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- What are Relationships
- Master-Detail Relationship
- Cascade Delete
- Lookup Relationship
- Roll-Up Summary Fields
- Lookup vs Master-Detail

1 Introduction 0:00 – 0:45

So far we've built Objects, Fields, Records, Lightning Pages, and Dynamic Forms. But what if **two objects need to be connected**? A Student belongs to a College. An Employee works in a Department. A Contact belongs to an Account. That's what **Relationships** solve.

> **Covered today:** What Relationships are • Why we need them • Lookup Relationship • Master-Detail Relationship • Real-life examples • Practical demos • Lookup vs Master-Detail

2 What are Relationships? 0:45 – 2:30

In a school, every Student belongs to a Class, every Teacher teaches Classes, and every Class belongs to a Department. These records are all connected. Salesforce works the same way — objects don't stay isolated, they connect.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

A Relationship connects two objects so related records can be linked together

3 Why Do We Need Relationships? 2:30 – 4:00

Take a car showroom with three objects: **Customer**, **Vehicle**, and **Test Drive**. Without relationships, you'd have to manually remember which customer booked which vehicle.

With Relationships, Salesforce Connects Automatically



Key Benefits of Relationships

- Avoid duplicate data
- Connect business records
- Generate better reports
- Improve automation
- Maintain data consistency

4 Lookup Relationship 4:00 – 8:00

The most commonly used relationship type. A **Lookup Relationship** connects two objects, but both remain **independent** — each record can exist entirely on its own.

Example: A **Student** may have a **Course**. If the Course record is deleted, the Student record still exists — only the relationship link is removed. This makes Lookup a **loose connection**.

Features of Lookup Relationship

Feature	Behavior
Parent & Child	Independent of each other
Parent record	Optional
Child record	Can exist without a Parent
Roll-Up Summary Fields	Not supported
Deleting the Parent	Child is **not** automatically deleted
Ownership	Stays separate for each record

Real-Life Example: Employee → Department

Employee → Department (Lookup)

If a **Department** is deleted, the **Employee** record should still remain — you'd simply reassign that employee to another department later. This is a perfect Lookup use case.



✖ Delete Department → Employee "Rahul" still exists

5 Practical Demo — Lookup Relationship 9:00 – 11:00

1. Create two objects: **Department** and **Employee**.
2. Open **Employee** → create a new Relationship Field.
3. Choose **Lookup Relationship** → select **Department** as the related object.
4. Click **Save**.
5. Create a Department record: **IT**.
6. Create an Employee record: **Rahul**, with Department = IT.
7. Open the Employee record — you'll see it's connected to the Department.
8. Delete the Department record.

Result: The Employee record still exists after the Department is deleted — only the relationship link is removed.

6 Master-Detail Relationship 11:00 – 15:30

Unlike Lookup, **Master-Detail** creates a very strong connection. The Child record **cannot exist without the Parent**. If the Parent is deleted, all Child records are automatically deleted too — this is called **Cascade Delete**.

IN SIMPLE WORDS

The Child completely depends on the Parent

Features of Master-Detail Relationship

Feature	Behavior
Parent-Child bond	Strong (tightly coupled)
Child record	Cannot exist without a Parent
Parent field	Mandatory
Roll-Up Summary Fields	Supported
Deleting the Parent	Cascade Delete — all Children deleted too
Ownership	Child inherits Owner, Sharing & Security from Parent

7 Roll-Up Summary Fields 15:30 – 16:30

One of the biggest advantages of Master-Detail: Salesforce can **automatically calculate values** from Child records — no code required.

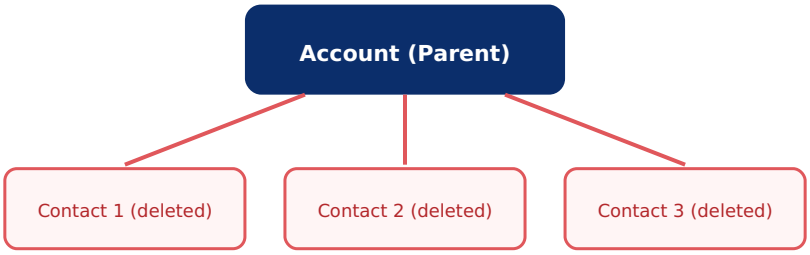
Example: Order → Order Item

Total Quantity **Total Amount** **Maximum Price** **Minimum Price**

> **Important:** Roll-Up Summary Fields are available **only** in Master-Detail Relationships — not in Lookup.

8 Cascade Delete 16:30 – 17:00

Suppose an **Account** has five **Contacts** connected via Master-Detail. Deleting the Account automatically deletes all five Contacts too.



Deleting the Parent (Account) cascades down and deletes every Child (Contact) automatically.

9 Ownership & Sharing 17:00 – 17:40

In a Master-Detail Relationship, the Child record **doesn't have its own owner**. It automatically inherits:

Owner **Sharing Settings** **Security**

...directly from the Parent record, keeping data secure and consistent.

10 Practical Demo — Master-Detail 17:40 – 19:30

1. Create two objects: **Order** and **Order Item**.
2. Create a **Master-Detail Relationship** on Order Item, pointing to Order. Notice Parent is mandatory.
3. Create an **Order** record.
4. Create multiple **Order Item** records linked to that Order.
5. Create a **Roll-Up Summary Field** on Order — choose **SUM of Amount**.
6. Salesforce automatically calculates the total.
7. Delete the **Order** record.

> **Result:** All Order Items are deleted automatically along with the Order — that's Cascade Delete in action.

11 Lookup vs. Master-Detail

19:30 – 21:00

Lookup Relationship

- Loose relationship
- Parent is optional
- Child exists independently
- No Roll-Up Summary
- No Cascade Delete
- Separate ownership

Master-Detail Relationship

- Strong relationship
- Parent is mandatory
- Child depends on Parent
- Supports Roll-Up Summary
- Cascade Delete
- Inherits Owner & Sharing

Memory Trick

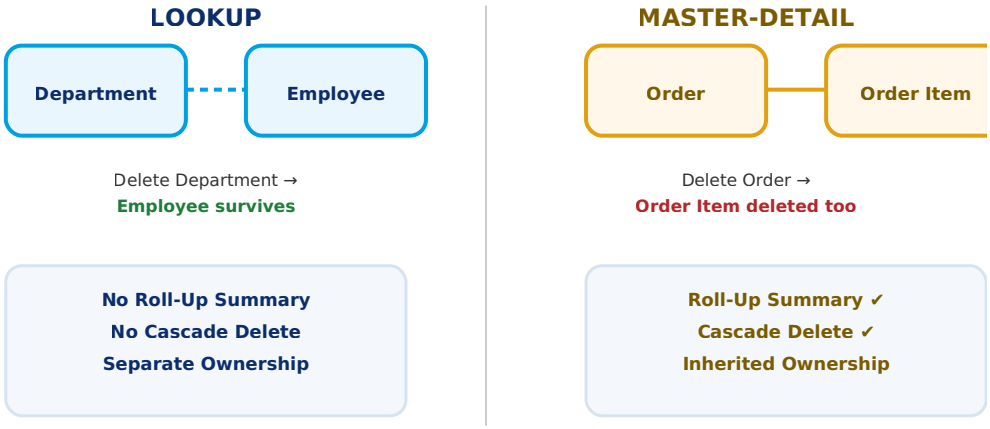
LOOKUP

Independent Friends

MASTER-DETAIL

Parent & Child

12 Both Relationships — Side-by-Side Recap



13 Episode Summary 21:00 – 21:30

- ✔ Relationships connect objects so related records can be linked together
- ✔ They prevent duplicate data, power reports, and enable automation
- ✔ **Lookup** = loose, optional, independent records, no Roll-Up, no Cascade Delete
- ✔ **Master-Detail** = strong, mandatory parent, supports Roll-Up Summary & Cascade Delete
- ✔ Roll-Up Summary Fields auto-calculate values from Child records (Master-Detail only)
- ✔ Cascade Delete removes all Children when the Parent is deleted (Master-Detail only)
- ✔ Master-Detail Children inherit Owner, Sharing, and Security from the Parent

Coming up next: *More advanced relationship types —* ***Self Relationship***, ***Hierarchical Relationship***, ***Many-to-Many Relationship***, ***Junction Object***, ***External Lookup***, *and* ***Indirect Lookup Relationship***.